Rainbow – the chakra system

White has **no stripe of its own** in the rainbow. Sunlight, which we perceive as white, contains various wavelengths. Water drops separate them when a rainbow forms, so we see a colour spectrum. White light and white paint on a canvas are not the same thing, though. In some contemporary approaches it accompanies the **crown chakra** and the themes of wholeness and transcendence.

The whole rainbow as a map of questions

Red · root
Support, safety, presence. Ask yourself. What can I lean on?

Orange · sacral
Experiencing, pleasure, sensuality. Ask yourself. What does me good?

Yellow · solar plexus
Self-worth, will, decision-making. Ask yourself. What do I want to choose for myself?

Green · heart
Closeness, kindness, relationships. Ask yourself. Where can I be open and still stay with myself?

Blue · throat
Voice, expression, communication. Ask yourself. What do I need to say?

Indigo · third eye
Inner vision, intuition, discernment. Ask yourself. What is beginning to dawn on me?

Violet · crown
Transcendence, meaning, connection. Ask yourself. What gives me a wider sense of meaning?

White · beside the crown
Space and a breath. Ask yourself. Must I fill every free spot with something at once?

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The crown chakra and transcendence without obligation

Chakras come from the Indian yogic and tantric tradition. The seventh chakra is called Sahasrara and in classical texts violet or light is linked with it. White is added to it only in some contemporary spiritual approaches, beside violet, with the themes of wholeness and meaning.

White here is not a confirmation that someone has reached a higher stage of development. A white dress can be beautiful. A spiritual certificate is not included with it, though. The assignments also differ among traditions.

When white does you good. It brings you relief, quiet and fewer stimuli. You feel fresh in it and have room for your own decisions.

When white does not do you good. You feel that nothing must be spoiled, or it reminds you of a hospital or an unlived-in flat. These are not proofs of the state of a chakra. They are situations in which you can get to know yourself.

A space that is not emptiness

- **Put it beside**
  White paper next to a colour that attracts you. Perceive them for a while without looking for the right meaning.
- **Leave the sheet empty**
  Lay a white paper in front of you. You need not write an intention or come up with an answer at once. Notice what it is like to leave it empty for a while.
- **Put it on**
  A simple white T-shirt or shirt after a period full of changes. Fewer stimuli, less need to explain yourself.
- **Put it in a room**
  One light wall, shelf or lamp. A light wall does not behave like a white room.
- **Paint it**
  One thin layer of white on coloured paper. Notice your hand, the pressure and whether you want to continue.
- **Open the window**
  Daylight and fresh air do more for a space than the colour of the wall.

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When there is already too much white

The meaning of the search can turn into another obligation. You keep reading, looking for explanations and trying to work out what life "wants to tell you". Until there is no room left simply to live something. If emptiness unsettles you, you can add colour, touch a table or look around the room. **You do not need more white.** You need to invite tangible colours.

- **With brown**
  Do I feel support and my body?
- **With red**
  Is there room for strength and anger?
- **With green**
  Do I have closeness and breath?
- **With black**
  Do I see a clear contrast that helps me tell things apart?

This is inspiration from tradition, not treatment. It is not about measuring chakras. You notice how the relationship of colours affects you and what theme it reminds you of.

Picture it with an example

Next to white other colours can feel calmer. Red gets its surroundings, yellow softens, green recalls spring leaves on a light wall. **These are possibilities for personal reading**, not effects prescribed by a colour combination.

How to use this map

It is a way to sort out the themes you are living through. Do you add a colour because you miss liveliness, or do you not need it because calm is enough? **You choose the meaning.** Both options can be fine.

White has no eighth place in the classical seven-colour map.

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